

Nanda dynasty of Magadha was founded after the end of Shishunaga dynasty. There were 9 kings in Nanda dynasty- (1) Ugrasen, called Mahapadma in Puranas (2) Panduk (3) Pandugati (4) Bhootpal (5) Rastrapal (6) Govishanak (7) Dashasiddhak (8) Kaivart (9) Dhanananda. During last years of Nanda dynasty, people became turbulent because of extortion and imposing heavy taxes on small items. By taking advantage of this, Chandragupta Maurya with the help of Chanakya killed Dhanananda and established Maurya Empire. Thus, option (a) is the correct answer.

19. Who was the last King of Karnata dynasty?

- (a) Harisimha
- (b) Ramsimha
- (c) Matisimha
- (d) Shyamsimha
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

The last ruler of Karnata Dynasty was Harisimha Dev. He was a great patron of art and literature. He was the pro-founder of Panji system.

Greek Invasion

1. Which one of the following rulers of Magadha was the contemporary of Alexander, the Great?

- (a) Mahapadmananda
- (b) Dhanananda
- (c) Sukalpa
- (d) Chandragupta Maurya

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

There were eight inheritors of Mahapadmananda found in purans and Buddhist texts. Dhanananda was the ruler contemporary of Alexander, the Great Greek writers referred him to as Agrammes.

2. Who wrote the Periplus of the Erythraen Sea?

- (a) Tessius
- (b) Pliny
- (c) Ptolemy
- (d) Strabo

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (*)

The 'Periplus of the Erythraean Sea' is a Greco-Roman periplus (manuscript document). It describes the opportunities for navigation and trade from the ports of Roman Egypt. It was written by an anonymous sailor from Alexandria. It has also mentioned the items to be imported and exported from India.

Maurya Empire

1. The first Empire was established by which ruler in India?

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
- (b) Ashoka
- (c) Kanishka
- (d) Chandragupta-II Vikramaditya
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

Chandragupta Maurya is considered one of the greatest emperors of India. He was the first emperor who brought together the small fragmented kingdoms of the country and combined them into a single large empire. He expanded his empire to the edge of what is now known as Iran. He was the one who first unified India politically.

2. Chandragupta Maurya figures prominently in the book of –

- (a) Bhasa
- (b) Sudraka
- (c) Vishakhadatta
- (d) Ashvaghosha

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Mudrarakshasa authored by Vishakhadatta provides various information about the reign of Chandragupta Maurya. Dhundiraja had written a commentary on Mudrarakshasa. In this drama, Chandragupta is described as the son of Nandiraja. This book depicts Chandragupta as "Vrishal" and "Kulheen".

3. Who recognized Sandrokottos as Chandra Gupta Maurya?

- (a) William Jones
- (b) V. Smith
- (c) R. K. Mukherjee
- (d) D. R. Bhandarkar

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

William Jones was the first scholar who recognized Sandrokottos as Chandra Gupta Maurya. Arian and Plutarch also described him as Androkottos.

4. Kautilya's Arthashastra is a book on -

- (a) Economic relations
- (b) Principles and practice of statecraft
- (c) Foreign policy
- (d) Wealth accumulation
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (e)